

Third Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Tertia Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: humility, vigilance, and the shepherd's joy

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Respice in me, et miserere mei</i> (Ps. 24)	Poverty before God	St. Augustine, Enarrationes in Psalmos; St. Francis of Assisi	The soul begins as solitary and poor, but poverty becomes the place where mercy is seen.
Collect	God as protector; temporal goods passed through toward eternal goods	Pilgrimage and right use	St. Gregory of Nyssa on ascent; St. Augustine, City of God XIX	Temporal goods are not despised but traversed under God's rule.
Epistle	1 Pet. 5:6-11	Humility under God's hand; vigilance against the devil	St. Leo the Great on humility; St. Anthony and desert vigilance	The Christian resists not by self-trust but by sober humility and faith.
Gospel	Luke 15:1-10	Lost sheep and lost drachma	St. Ambrose on Luke; St. Gregory the Great on pastoral care	The murmuring of the righteous is answered by heaven's joy over repentance.
Offertory	<i>Sperant in te omnes</i> (Ps. 9)	Trust of the poor	St. Basil on care for the poor	The poor are not forgotten; the offering becomes their prayer in the Church.
Communion	<i>Gaudium est Angelis Dei</i> (Luke 15:10)	Angelic joy over one sinner	St. Bernard on conversion; St. Therese of Lisieux on confidence	Communion is not a prize for the never-lost but the feast of being found.

Thread	Synthesis
Humility and mercy	Peter's command to humble ourselves prepares us to be found. The sheep is carried because it cannot restore itself.
Vigilance and joy	The devil hunts by isolation and despair; the Gospel answers with a shepherd who searches and a heaven that rejoices.
Prayer focus	Replace anxious self-repair with a concrete act of humble confession and renewed trust in the Shepherd.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Tertia post Pentecosten*.

- Suggested patristic study: Ambrose on Luke 15; Gregory the Great, Pastoral Rule; Augustine on Psalm 24.